

FREQUENTLY ASKED INTERVIEW QUESTIONS – CONSULTING

*Note: ** denotes the most frequently asked questions*

Fit with Consulting Role

- Walk me through your resume/Tell me about yourself. **
- Why do you want to be a consultant? **
- Why did you choose Chicago Booth? **
- How do you believe your experiences qualify you for consulting?
- Why did you decide to leave your previous career?
- What scares you the most about consulting?
- Can you handle the consulting lifestyle?
- Why are you interested in [a certain type of] consulting?
- Convince me that I should hire you. What makes you unique compared to your peers?

Fit with the Firm

- Why do you want to join our firm? What other firms have you applied to? **
- Why did you choose this office?
- What questions do you have about our firm? **
- What other companies are you interviewing with?
- What makes our company different from our competitors?
- How will you decide between firms?
- What are you looking for in a consulting firm?

Analytical skills

- Tell me about a time when you had to convince someone of something using data. **
- How do you think consultants are able to justify the prices they charge?
- Tell me about a time when you solved a difficult problem in your most recent job? How did you solve the problem and what was the outcome?

Leadership skills

- What was your most significant leadership experience? **
- Tell me about one of the toughest clients that you've had. What made it difficult? What did you do? **
- Tell me about a difficult interpersonal relationship. **
- How do you define leadership?
- What is the one thing I should take back to my fellow interviewers to remember you by?
- Tell me three instances of when you were most proud of yourself.
- What was the most challenging or riskiest decision you have made?
- How do you set targets? How do you quantify and measure the outcomes?
- Which leader is your role model and why? How has he/she influenced you?
- There are always times when we have to make a decision with less than perfect information, either because the information is not available, or there is not enough time. Tell me about a time when you made the best possible decision despite less than perfect conditions.
- Tell me about a time that you failed.

Team Skills

- Describe a team experience that did not work well. Why didn't it work well? How did you handle it? **
- Have you ever been in a situation where a team member was not holding up his or her end of the project? What happened?
- Describe a team experience that worked well. Why did it work well? **
- Tell me the advantages & disadvantages of teamwork.
- Provide an example of an unpleasant client situation. How did you handle it? What would you have done differently?
- Tell me about a time when your opinion was challenged. How did you handle it?
- Give me an example of when you were a mentor to someone else.
- Describe a time where you resolved a disagreement.
- Tell me about a time that you disagreed with your superior? How did you resolve the situation?
- Provide an example of how you have successfully used a network within an organization.
- How would other members of your teams in business school describe you?
- Can you tell me about a time you worked with a client and you have to give them news or information you knew they didn't want to hear?
- Describe a time when you had to convince a person or group to re-evaluate their decision.

Additional Questions About Your Fit with the Firm / Role

- Describe a situation where you had to work with ambiguity. How did you deal with the situation and what was the result? **
- Describe an experience when you had to convince someone/a peer/a manager? **
- Provide an example of your creative skills.
- Tell me about a time you had to creatively solve a problem. What was the problem, and how did you go about solving it?
- Describe your skills and experience with presentations.
- What is something you are passionate about?
- On your last performance evaluation, what was something you needed to work on?
- What do you do for fun?
- What motivates you?
- What is the most influential invention of all time? Why?
- How would you feel to be in consulting with colleagues who are possibly 4-5 years younger or older than you are?
- Do you think you will be able to handle the extremely structured work environment of consulting?